

Matthew Espinosa

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Narrative designer specializing in immersive storytelling, branching structure, and worldbuilding. 6+ years crafting in games and physical interactive media. Collaborative creator who cherishes unique voices and rewarding player experiences.

Independent Creative Work

Freelance

White River Junction, VT

Developer, Designer, Writer

2023–Present

- Led two game jam projects both as an artist and a project lead, collaborating in Unity and Godot. Created animated sprites and storyboarded cinematic intro/outro sequences for two vibrant, small-scope games: a *Pizza Tower* and *Donkey Kong Country* inspired platformer and a whimsical tower “offense” game. Balanced storytelling with gameplay under tight time constraints.

Professional Experience

EscapeWorks Denver

Denver, CO

Game Design Manager

2018–2023

- Led the development of immersive escape room storylines, scripting original narrative and designing thematic puzzles that enhanced player engagement.
- Re-imagined older experiences into new seasonal favorites often mentioned in Google Reviews, such as *Outbreak '95* and *Haunting at the Speakeasy*.
- Directed creative workshops among coworkers to refine and develop story concepts and ensure brand consistency within each experience.

The Hive

Parker, CO

Creative Technology Professional

Summer 2023

- Guided local artists in a Makerspace setting to develop digital art that reflected their creative visions, elevating creative concepts through customized 3D printing and laser engraving.

Border Crossing Literary Journal

Sault Ste. Marie, MI

Editor Internship

Winter 2017

- Collaborated with fellow editors sorting through hundreds of short stories, comics, and poems for publication. Edited submissions and offered advice to authors. Submitted a SEO-optimized book review of *House of Women* by Sophie Goldstein.

Education

Lake Superior State University

Sault Ste. Marie, MI

B.A. Creative Writing, minor in History, with Honors — GPA 3.88

Workshops and Creative Training

CCS Horror Comics (2025), *CalArts Narrative Design (2021)*, *ENMU El Portal Workshop (2013)*

Skills & Awards

Programming: HTML/CSS, GDScript, Arduino, Python

Writing Tools: Celtx, Scrivener, Twine, Articy Draft

Art Tools: Clip Studio Paint, Aseprite, Photoshop, Blender

Awards: Excellence in Literary Studies (LSSU, 2018), Best Space Western (ENMU, 2011)